

June 1, 2026

Anabel Bonney — Principal

Sherman Oaks Center for Enriched Studies Magnet (LAUSD)

18605 Erwin St, Reseda, CA 91335

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(818) 758-5600

Application materials directed to Susana Mora, susana.mora@lausd.net, per the posting.

Dear Principal Bonney,

I am applying for the math teaching position at SOCES Magnet for the 2026-2027 school year — sending materials to Mrs. Mora per the listing instructions, and writing directly to you to introduce myself. I bring a BSc in Mathematics and Computer Science from Brown, fifteen years as a software engineer at Apple, Cisco, and Goldman Sachs, and five years founding and teaching at Dragon and Crane Dojo, a small private school I built from the ground up. I am turning toward LAUSD because I want to spend the next phase of my work in a public school classroom serving the families I most want to serve.

A gifted and highly-gifted magnet asks its math teachers to work at both ends of the ability range simultaneously, and the gifted track in particular is one I want to teach into — not by accelerating procedural drill, but by giving students problems that reward thought. That is the instinct I bring to the off-the-mat curriculum at my dojo, where I teach chess, coding, and physics to students whose appetite for hard problems is larger than what their day-school workload can absorb. At Dragon and Crane I have already done the work of writing and self-publishing my own curriculum, sequencing multi-year arcs, and tracking individual student progress, so the lesson-design foundations are in place.

My industry background also lets me answer the question every math student eventually asks — when am I going to use this? I have used it: settlement systems at Goldman Sachs, network management APIs at Apple, clinical AI infrastructure at Deep6 AI. For gifted students especially, math deserves a teacher who can show what it grows into.

Thank you for your consideration. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how I can best serve SOCES's students and families.

Sincerely,

David Chung

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